

Lesson Plan: History

Period 1: Setting the Stage: Colonial Rule and the Roots of Discontent (45 min)

Objectives: Recall key facts about British colonial rule and the East India Company's expansion in India; Describe the decline of the Mughal Empire and its political consequences; Define the Doctrine of Lapse and explain how it was used to annex Indian states; Explain the political, economic, social and religious causes that led to widespread discontent before 1857

Concepts: Doctrine of Lapse, Causes of the Revolt of 1857

Period 2: The Spark: The Enfield Rifle Cartridge Controversy (40 min)

Objectives: Describe the incident of the Enfield rifle cartridges and its religious sensitivities; Distinguish between the underlying causes and the immediate trigger of the revolt; Analyze how a single incident escalated pre-existing grievances into open rebellion

Concepts: Immediate Cause: Enfield Rifle Cartridges, Causes of the Revolt of 1857

Period 3: Centres of Rebellion and Their Leaders (45 min)

Objectives: Identify the major centres of the revolt (Meerut, Delhi, Kanpur, Lucknow, Jhansi, Bareilly, Arrah); Identify the key leaders associated with each centre (Bahadur Shah Zafar, Nana Sahib, Rani Lakshmibai, Tantia Tope, Begum Hazrat Mahal); Locate the major centres of the revolt accurately on a map of India; Explain the role each leader played in organizing resistance in their region

Concepts: Major Centres of the Revolt

Period 4: Why the Revolt Failed (45 min)

Objectives: List the major military, organizational and leadership weaknesses of the rebel forces; Analyze how lack of unity among Indian rulers and communities contributed to failure; Compare the resources and strategies of the British with those of the rebels; Evaluate which factor was most decisive in the collapse of the revolt

Concepts: Reasons for Failure of the Revolt

Period 5: Aftermath: Consequences for Governance and Society (45 min)

Objectives: Describe the major administrative and policy changes following the revolt, including the end of Company rule; Explain how British attitudes and policies toward Indian rulers, army, and society changed after 1857; Analyze the extent to which these consequences addressed or ignored the original causes of the revolt

Concepts: Consequences of the Revolt

Period 6: Legacy of 1857: First War of Independence? (40 min)

Objectives: Explain differing historical interpretations of the revolt as a 'sepoy mutiny' versus 'First War of Independence'; Evaluate the long-term significance of the revolt in shaping Indian nationalism and the freedom struggle; Construct a well-supported argument, using evidence from causes, centres, failure and consequences, on the historical significance of the revolt

Concepts: Historical Significance / First War of Independence